

Day 89 — TNPSC Group 2A Study Material

Part A – General Studies: Current Affairs in TN History/Culture/Heritage (6): Tamil Nadu's New 'Semmozhi National Literary Award'

READING MATERIAL

Covers Tamil Nadu's newly launched state literary honour — the Semmozhi National Literary Award.

Q: What is the 'Semmozhi National Literary Award', and when/where was it announced?

A: A new annual national-level literary award launched by the Tamil Nadu government, announced by Chief Minister M.K. Stalin in January 2026, at the closing ceremony of the Chennai International Book Fair 2026.

Q: Which 7 languages does the award cover in its first phase?

A: Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia, Bengali, and Marathi.

Q: What is the cash prize for each Semmozhi National Literary Award?

A: ₹5 lakh per award.

Q: How will winners be selected, per the announcement?

A: Independent juries comprising eminent writers and award-winning authors will be constituted separately for EACH language, to ensure transparency and literary merit in the selection process.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. The Semmozhi National Literary Award was announced by Tamil Nadu's Chief Minister at:

A. The World Tamil Conference

B. The Chennai International Book Fair 2026 ✓

C. Republic Day celebrations

D. The Tamil Nadu Legislative Assembly

Explanation: The Chennai International Book Fair 2026. [medium, web-research]

2. In its first phase, the Semmozhi National Literary Award covers how many Indian languages?

A. 5

B. 6

C. 7 ✓

D. 8

Explanation: 7 (Tamil, Telugu, Kannada, Malayalam, Odia, Bengali, Marathi). [medium, web-research]

3. Which of these languages is NOT covered in the first phase of the Semmozhi National Literary Award?

A. Telugu

B. Marathi

C. Hindi ✓

D. Odia

Explanation: Hindi is not among the 7 first-phase languages. [hard, web-research]

4. The cash prize for each Semmozhi National Literary Award is:

A. ₹1 lakh

B. ₹3 lakh

C. ₹5 lakh ✓

D. ₹10 lakh

Explanation: ₹5 lakh. [medium, web-research]

5. How are winners selected for the Semmozhi National Literary Award?

A. A single national committee for all languages

B. Independent juries constituted separately for each language ✓

C. Public online voting

D. Direct selection by the Chief Minister

Explanation: Independent juries for each language. [medium, web-research]

Part B – Aptitude & Mental Ability: Volume

READING MATERIAL

Volume is the last of 10 named Aptitude sub-skills. Real exam evidence shows two dominant shapes: 'ratio of dimensions → ratio of volumes' (scaling), and 'melt/recast one solid into another shape' (volume is conserved, surface area is not) — both are core techniques worth knowing cold.

Q: Method — ratio of volumes from a ratio of radii (same shape): If the radius of one sphere is half that of another, what is the ratio of their volumes?

A: Volume scales with the CUBE of linear dimensions ($V = \frac{4}{3}\pi r^3$), not directly with the radius. So if $r_1:r_2 = 1:2$, then $V_1:V_2 = 1^3:2^3 = 1:8$.

Q: Method — melting and recasting (volume is conserved, NOT surface area): A sphere of radius 9cm is melted and recast into a cone of the same radius (9cm). Find the cone's height.

A: Set sphere volume = cone volume: $(\frac{4}{3})\pi(9)^3 = (\frac{1}{3})\pi(9)^2h \rightarrow (\frac{4}{3})(729) = (\frac{1}{3})(81)h \rightarrow 972 = 27h \rightarrow h = 36$ cm. The general shortcut: for melting sphere→cone of the SAME radius, height = 4×radius always (since the $(\frac{4}{3})r^3$ vs $(\frac{1}{3})r^2h$ relationship reduces to $h=4r$ when radii match).

Q: Real exam (already seen in an earlier topic, re-noted here): A sphere of diameter 8cm is melted and drawn into a wire of diameter 3mm. Find the wire's length.

A: Volume conserved: $(\frac{4}{3})\pi(4)^3 = \pi(0.15)^2 \times h \rightarrow h \approx 3792.6$ cm ≈ 37.9 m. (Same melt/recast principle as r02, just sphere→cylinder/wire instead of sphere→cone.)

Q: Method — volume of a cylindrical tank from its capacity: A cylindrical tank has capacity 1,848 m³ and base diameter 14m. Find its depth.

A: $V = \pi r^2 h \rightarrow 1848 = (\frac{22}{7}) \times 7^2 \times h = 154h \rightarrow h = 12$ m.

Q: Method — dug-out soil redistributed into a different shape (volume conserved): A cylindrical well of depth 20m, diameter 14m is dug; the soil is spread evenly to form a cuboid platform of base 20m×14m. Find the platform's height.

A: Well volume = $(\frac{22}{7}) \times 7^2 \times 20 = 3,080$ m³. Platform volume = $20 \times 14 \times h = 280h$. Set equal: $280h = 3080 \rightarrow h = 11$ m.

Q: Formula check: volume of a cube with side 5cm, and the relationship between a cube's volume and surface area.

A: Volume = side³ = $5^3 = 125$ cm³. If a cube's volume is 1000 cm³, its side = $\sqrt[3]{1000} = 10$ cm, so its surface area = $6 \times \text{side}^2 = 6 \times 100 = 600$ cm² (cube surface area = $6 \times \text{side}^2$, from its 6 square faces).

Q: Method — ratio of volumes for cone, sphere, cylinder of equal radius AND equal height: What is that ratio?

A: Cone : Sphere : Cylinder = 1 : 4 : 3, when all three share the same radius r and the same height h (for the sphere, 'height' = its diameter = 2r in this comparison). This is a frequently tested ratio worth memorizing directly.

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. If the radius of sphere A is 3 times the radius of sphere B, what is the ratio of their volumes (A:B)?

- A. 3:1
- B. 9:1
- C. 27:1 ✓**
- D. 6:1

Explanation: Volume ratio = (radius ratio)³ = $3^3:1^3 = 27:1$. [easy, authored]

2. A solid sphere of radius 6cm is melted and recast into a cone of the same radius. Find the cone's height.

- A. 18 cm
- B. 24 cm ✓**
- C. 12 cm
- D. 6 cm

Explanation: Using the shortcut $h = 4 \times \text{radius}$ for sphere→same-radius-cone: $h = 4 \times 6 = 24$ cm. [medium, authored]

3. A cylindrical tank has capacity 4,620 m³ and base diameter 14m. Find its depth.

- A. 20 m
- B. 25 m
- C. 30 m ✓**

D. 15 m

Explanation: $V = \pi r^2 h \rightarrow 4620 = (22/7) \times 49 \times h = 154h \rightarrow h = 30\text{m}$. [medium, authored]

4. Find the volume of a cube with side 8cm.

A. 512 cm³ ✓

B. 256 cm³

C. 64 cm³

D. 640 cm³

Explanation: $8^3 = 512\text{ cm}^3$. [easy, authored]

5. If a cube's volume is 2,197 cm³, find its surface area.

A. 507 cm²

B. 169 cm²

C. 1014 cm² ✓

D. 338 cm²

Explanation: Side = $\sqrt[3]{2197} = 13\text{cm}$. Surface area = $6 \times 13^2 = 6 \times 169 = 1,014\text{ cm}^2$. [medium, authored]

6. A cone, a sphere, and a cylinder share the same radius and same height. What is the ratio of their volumes (cone:sphere:cylinder)?

A. 1:3:4

B. 1:4:3 ✓

C. 3:4:1

D. 4:3:1

Explanation: Cone:Sphere:Cylinder = 1:4:3 for equal radius and height. [medium, web-research]

Part C – General English: Poem: "The Age of Chivalry" — George Krokos

READING MATERIAL

A poem (from the Samacheer Kalvi Class 7/10 English anthology, depending on edition) celebrating knightly adventure, romance, and idealism. Real coaching-site evidence shows TNPSC tests figures of speech, the poem's theme, AND in-context vocabulary meaning roughly equally — cover all three.

Q: What is the poem about, in brief?

A: Knights in the Age of Chivalry were strong, bold, and carried swords/lances, covering themselves in shining armour and seeking romance. They fought for righteous causes, displayed valour, and won their lady-love's affection through adventures aimed at goodness and sacrifice. The poem's main theme is Adventure and Chivalry.

Q: What did knights mainly fight for, according to the poem?

A: Show, love, and glory — not money, revenge, or peace.

Q: What is the poet's view on imagination, per this poem?

A: Imagination leads to adventure — it's portrayed positively, as the spark for adventurous, chivalric ideals, not as something that 'causes problems' or 'blocks reality'.

Q: What does "shining armour" represent in the poem?

A: Glory and honour — not literally just metal or wealth.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "adventures hide themselves" and "abated breath."

A: Both are cited as Personification — giving 'adventures' a human-like ability to 'hide', and 'breath' the ability to be 'abated' (held back), as if it were acting with intent.

Q: Identify the figure of speech: "Maybe life itself is one big adventure."

A: Metaphor — life is directly equated with 'one big adventure', without using 'like/as'.

Q: In context, what does "you bounce a bit" convey, and what does "transparent" mean here?

A: "You bounce a bit" conveys excitement (a physical sign of eager energy). "Transparent" in this poem means being open to experience, not literally see-through.

Q: In context, what do "embrace you" and "days of yore" mean?

A: "Embrace you" means to welcome closely. "Days of yore" refers to ancient times (the historical setting of knights and chivalry).

MOCK TEST (WITH ANSWERS)

1. "The Age of Chivalry" is written by:

- A. John Keats
- B. George Krokos ✓**
- C. William Wordsworth
- D. Robert Frost

Explanation: George Krokos. [easy, web-research]

2. The main theme of "The Age of Chivalry" is:

- A. Friendship
- B. Nature
- C. Adventure and Chivalry ✓**
- D. Romance alone

Explanation: Adventure and Chivalry. [easy, web-research]

3. According to the poem, knights fought mainly for:

- A. Money
- B. Revenge
- C. Show, love and glory ✓**
- D. Peace

Explanation: Show, love, and glory. [easy, web-research]

4. "Shining armour" in the poem represents:

A. Cowardice

B. Glory and honour ✓

C. Metal

D. Wealth

Explanation: Glory and honour. [medium, web-research]

5. Identify the figure of speech in "adventures hide themselves."

A. Simile

B. Metaphor

C. Personification ✓

D. Alliteration

Explanation: Personification — adventures are given the human ability to 'hide'. [medium, web-research]

6. Identify the figure of speech in "Maybe life itself is one big adventure."

A. Metaphor ✓

B. Simile

C. Irony

D. Personification

Explanation: Metaphor — life is directly equated with adventure. [medium, web-research]

7. In the poem, "transparent" is used to mean:

A. Invisible

B. Open to experience ✓

C. Weak

D. Lost

Explanation: Open to experience. [medium, web-research]

8. "Days of yore" refers to:

A. Modern age

B. Ancient times ✓

C. The future

D. Teenage years

Explanation: Ancient times. [easy, web-research]